WORKSHEET 4 OF 7

First-Call Script and Question Lists

Pages to copy. These come from chapter 9, "The Walk and the Owner Call". Chapter 4 covers the owner's full written inquiry to the utility, and the sample documents include the letter.

Before you use it. Put the script in your own words. Follow your broker's policies and your state's rules on prospecting calls, including any do-not-call procedure. On the owner's property, follow the owner's rules. Do not open or touch electrical equipment, and do not enter an electrical room alone.

Page 1. The ninety-second owner script

The only goal of this call: a site visit and one electric bill.

Before you dial:

- ☐ The building has been through the ten-minute screen. Result: go and see it.
- ☐ My broker knows which building I am calling about.
- ☐ I checked whether another brokerage has the listing.
- ☐ I followed my office's calling rules.

1. Who you are

> "Hello, is this _____? My name is _____. I am a commercial real estate agent with _____ in _____. Do you have two minutes?"

2. Why them

> "I am calling about your building on _____. It came up in my research in the public records, because of what it was built for. This is not an offer, and I do not have a buyer yet."

3. The reason to listen

> "AI companies are reported to be looking for existing buildings that already have heavy power. I am finding out which buildings here could qualify for a closer look. If yours can, you will know something about it that most owners do not. If it cannot, I will tell you why."

4. The ask

> "I would like twenty minutes with you at the building. I would like to see the main electrical room with you, without opening anything, and one electric bill from a year when the building was running at full production."

5. No pressure

> "Afterward I will tell you what I saw, and which questions only your utility and an engineer can answer. If it does not look like a fit, I will tell you why, and it will have cost you twenty minutes. Would _____ or _____ work?"

Do not say

- A price.
- "I have a buyer," unless you do.
- Any number of megawatts.
- That the building "works", "fits" or "is ready".

If the owner says no: "Would it be all right if I sent you a one-page note about what I was looking for, in case it is ever useful?" Send it (a sample is in the sample documents). Leave them alone.

If the owner starts talking: let them. Take notes.

Visit set for: _____ Bill offered: yes / no Notes written same day: ☐

Page 2. Questions for the owner

Ask two or three on the phone. Bring the rest to the visit. Write the answer, the date and who said it.

The building's history

- [ ] What was made or done here, and when did full operation stop?
- [ ] Is the building in use, leased or vacant today? Any plans for it?

Power

- [ ] Which electric utility serves you? Is the account active?
- [ ] Could I see bills from a busy year? Twelve months if you have them.
- [ ] Is there a single-line diagram or any electrical drawings?
- [ ] Is there a substation or large transformer on the site? Who owns it, you or the utility?
- [ ] Was any electrical equipment removed when operations stopped?
- [ ] Are there generators? What do they back up?

Structure and site

- [ ] Do you have the original structural drawings, especially the slab and foundations?
- [ ] Did any heavy machines sit on their own foundations? Were pits filled later?
- [ ] Has water ever stood in the yard or come into the building?
- [ ] Do you have a survey or a site plan?

Fiber

- [ ] Who provides internet and phone service? Was there ever a second provider?

Environment and title

- [ ] Are there any environmental reports?
- [ ] Is there a mortgage, lien, easement or recorded restriction on use?
- [ ] Who else owns the property with you? Who would have to agree to a sale or lease?
- [ ] Has anyone else approached you? Does anyone hold an option or an agreement?

The relationship

- [ ] Do you already work with a broker or an attorney on this property?

Documents to leave on the owner's list

- [ ] Electric bills from a full-production year.

- [ ] Single-line diagram and electrical drawings.
- [ ] Original structural drawings, and drawings of later changes.
- [ ] Survey or site plan.
- [ ] Roof information: age, and anything mounted on it.
- [ ] Environmental reports.
- [ ] Generator and fuel tank records.
- [ ] Telecom contracts or drawings showing where cables enter.
- [ ] Any letters from the utility about the service.

If a document does not exist, write "does not exist".

The sentence for the bill

> "A bill from _____ shows a peak demand of _____ kW. That is what the building drew then. It is not what the utility will serve today."

The sentence for the nameplate

> "Main switchgear nameplate: _____ volts, _____ amps. Utility capacity not confirmed."

Page 3. Questions for the utility

These go out from the owner, or from you with the owner's written permission. They are the first questions. Chapter 4 lists what a full written inquiry contains.

Sent by: _____ Date sent: _____ Written permission on file: ☐

- ☐ What service is installed at this address today, and is the account active?
- ☐ Is any capacity still committed to this site?
- ☐ How much can you serve here now, at the meter, without new construction?
- ☐ What would be needed to serve _____ MW, and by when?
- ☐ Who would pay for that work? Is there a study fee or a deposit?
- ☐ At what voltage would you serve a load of that size?
- ☐ Does your answer reserve capacity, and for how long?
- ☐ Who is the right contact for a request like this?
- ☐ Which rate schedule would a load of that size take?
- ☐ Please reply in writing.

The amount in the blank is the owner's decision, made with a buyer's requirement or an engineer's advice in hand. Ask for what the building and its yard can really use.

When the reply comes, record five things

- ☐ The amount, and whether it is stated at the meter.
- ☐ The date, and anything it depends on.
- ☐ The conditions: what has to be built, and by whom.
- ☐ The cost: study fee, contribution, deposit.
- ☐ The shelf life: whether the reply reserves anything, and for how long.

Until that reply is in the file, the page says: **"Utility capacity not confirmed."**